



MINHAJ SHAMEER AHAMED

CYBER SECURITY ANALYST & PENETRATION TESTER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Security Analyst & Penetration Tester with hands-on experience in Vulnerability Assessment and Penetration Testing (VAPT), Web and Network Security, and Threat Analysis. Skilled in tools such as Metasploit, Burp Suite, Nmap, and Wireshark, and proficient in Python and Bash scripting. Enterprise Defense Administrator (eEDA) certified and CompTIA Security+ (In Progress), with CEH v13 training and practical exposure through labs, internships, and real-world cybersecurity projects. Developed MetaWarden, a metadata detection and privacy risk analysis tool, as part of a BSc (Hons) Cyber Security degree completed with First-Class Honours, demonstrating strong capabilities in secure application development, forensic analysis, and privacy risk assessment. Experienced in conducting assessments aligned with the OWASP Top 10, Active Directory, and OS-level exploits. Strong in documentation, reporting, and analytical skills, with a continuous drive to advance both offensive and defensive cybersecurity expertise.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Freelance Penetration Tester (VAPT) – Self Employed

Apr 2025 - Present

United Arab Emirates

- Conduct independent penetration testing engagements on web applications, internal networks, and organizational systems
- Perform reconnaissance, vulnerability scanning, and security assessments using Nmap, Nessus, Metasploit, Burp Suite
- Identify and analyze security weaknesses including misconfigurations, authentication flaws, and application vulnerabilities
- Validate discovered vulnerabilities through controlled exploitation to demonstrate realistic attack impact
- Prepare comprehensive penetration testing reports including risk ratings and remediation recommendations
- Deliver security assessments and remediation re-testing services for organizations across the UAE

Penetration Testing (VAPT) Intern - RedTeam Hacker Academy

Dec 2025 - Mar 2026

Dubai, UAE

- Executed VAPT engagements on web applications, internal networks, and Android mobile applications
- Conducted reconnaissance and service enumeration using Nmap, Gobuster, WhatWeb, and Burp Suite
- Identified vulnerabilities including SQL Injection, authentication flaws, and input validation weaknesses
- Exploited Linux server vulnerabilities to achieve privilege escalation and root-level system access
- Produced penetration testing reports with CVSS risk ratings and remediation recommendations

IT Help Desk – Step Conference

Feb 2025

Dubai, UAE

- Provided technical support and troubleshooting for hardware, software, and network issues to conference attendees and staff.
- Ensured smooth operation of event technology, promptly addressing and resolving any technical difficulties.

Full Stack Web Development Intern – TCR Innovation

Jun 2023 - Oct 2023

Mumbai, India

- Developed websites using HTML and CSS, ensuring responsive and user-friendly interfaces.
- Collaborated with team members on web development projects, contributing to design and functionality improvements.

SKILLS

- **Offensive Security:** VAPT (Web, System, Network, Cloud)
- **Defensive Security:** SIEM, Log Analysis, Secure Configuration, Hardening.
- **Scripting & Languages:** Python, Bash, PowerShell (basic), SQL for automation and security tooling.
- **Tools & Technologies:** Nmap, Burp Suite, Sqlmap, Metasploit, Nessus, Wireshark, Hydra, CrackMapExec, Mimikatz, PowerView, BloodHound, OpenVAS, John the Ripper, Dirb, Kali Linux.
- **Security Frameworks & Standards:** Familiar with NIST CSF, NIST SP 800-30, ISO/IEC 27001.
- **Soft Skills:** Analytical Thinking, Problem-Solving, Attention to Detail, Communication, Team Collaboration, Adaptability.

PROJECTS

VAPT Multi-Domain Security Assessment – RedTeam Hacker Academy – [GitHub](#)

- Conducted vulnerability assessment and penetration testing across web applications, external/internal networks, and Android mobile applications following OWASP, PTES, and NIST SP 800-115 methodologies.
- Identified vulnerabilities including SQL injection authentication bypass, insecure configurations, exposed services, and privilege escalation paths; documented findings with CVSS ratings, proof-of-concept exploits, and remediation guidance.

MetaWarden: Metadata Detection & Privacy Risk Analysis Tool – Final Year Project – [GitHub](#)

- Developed a Python and Flask app to detect, analyze, and remove sensitive image metadata.
- Built a web interface with metadata extraction, privacy scoring (EXIF: GPS, device info, timestamps), and downloadable reports.

SignalForge: OT SOC Triage & Threat Detection Assistant – [GitHub](#)

- Developed a Python-based OT SOC tool to analyze industrial PCAPs and detect abnormal control system behavior.
- Implemented OT asset discovery, PLC baseline analysis, anomaly detection, alert fatigue reduction, and SOC-ready reporting.

LogSentry: Security Log Analysis & Alerting Tool – [GitHub](#)

- Developed a Python-based SOC/Blue Team tool to analyze authentication logs and detect suspicious activity.
- Implemented brute-force (high-volume & low-and-slow), suspicious IP, and privilege escalation detection.

EmailSleuth: Email Phishing Analyzer & Forensics Tool – [GitHub](#)

- Developed a Python-based cybersecurity tool to analyze .eml email files and identify phishing indicators.
- Implemented header forensics, sender spoofing detection, and SPF/DKIM/DMARC authentication analysis.

Hands-on Penetration Testing Lab (HackTheBox, TryHackMe, VulHub, PortSwigger)

- Simulated real-world attacks across web, network, and system layers in a controlled lab.
- Web Pentesting: Identified SQLi, XSS, and RCE using Burp Suite and Sqlmap. Manually exploited session management flaws.
- Active Directory: Performed Kerberoasting, Pass-the-Hash, and lateral movement using BloodHound, Mimikatz, and PowerView.
- Achieved root/system access on misconfigured Linux and Windows hosts via privilege escalation.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Enterprise Defense Administrator (eEDA) – [INE Security](#)
- Security Operation Center (SOC) in Practice – [IBM](#)
- CompTIA Security+ (Training)
- ISO/IEC 27001 & 42001 Lead Auditor – [Mastermind](#)
- Advanced Penetration Tester (APT) – [RedTeam Hacker Academy](#)
- Threat Intelligence & Hunting – [IBM](#)
- Certified API Hacking Expert (CAPIE) – [The XSS Rat Security](#)
- Penetration Testing Professional Certificate – [Cybrary](#)

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science (Hons) Cyber Security Engineering

Oct 2022 - Jul 2025

University of West London, RAK

- Classification: First-Class Honours
- Final Year Project: MetaWarden – Metadata Detection & Removal using Flask
- Key Modules: Cybersecurity Principles, Web Security, Digital Forensics, Computer Networks, Applied Cryptography, Machine Learning, Cyber Threat Analysis

COURSES

Cybersecurity Training – EC-Council's CEH v13 & Advanced Penetration Testing (APT)

Jun 2025 - Oct 2025

RedTeam Hacker Academy

- Trained in Ethical Hacking, Red Team Operations, and Advanced Exploitation Techniques
- Hands-on labs covering Web, Network, Active Directory, and OS-level attacks using industry-standard tools (Metasploit, Burp Suite, Nmap, Nessus, etc.)

CompTIA Security+ & INE Security's eEDA (Enterprise Defense Administrator)

Nov 2025 - Feb 2026

INE & RedTeam Hacker Academy

- Currently self-studying eEDA, focusing on security concepts, threat management, risk mitigation, and incident response.
- Delivered via INE and RedTeam Hacker Academy collaboration, emphasizing both theoretical knowledge and practical application.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: English (Fluent), Malayalam (Native), Hindi (Basic), Tamil (Proficient), Arabic (Elementary).

Licenses: LMV Driving License **Availability:** Immediate Joiner **D.O.B:** 09th Apr 2004 (21)